

Manchuria

another discontent group -> Kwantung Army in Manchuria.

Kwantung Army -> was created in 1906 -> to protect Japans assets in Manchuria.

Manchuria -> was seen as solution to Japans lack of natural resources as it was rich in vital substances such as iron and coal.

from 1916 -> regions in China -> were ruled by various warlords-> who fought for one another for power.

Initially -> Manchuria's warlord -> Zhang Zuolin -> developed friendly relations with Japan and the Kwantung Army.

Over the years -> inability to defend Japans interests in Manchuria -> would make Kwantung Army Increasingly frustrated with him.

Individual Branches:

Assassination of Zhang Zuolin, 1928

Mukden Incident, 1931

Growing Opposition to Civilian Government